BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #10 · CHRONIC PAIN

"People think I'm faking."

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Where it often comes from

Invisible pain and unpredictable symptoms leave room for doubt. Remarks like "But you look fine," or being accused of attention-seeking, hurt deeply. Some patients start hiding symptoms or over-explaining to prove they are sick.

What Scripture teaches

Job's friends accused him of hidden sin instead of believing his pain, and God rebuked them for not speaking about Him accurately, as His servant Job had (Job 42:7). Jesus had compassion on the suffering and never demanded that they prove it. "For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses." "Man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart." God sees what others cannot, and some people will believe you.

> *"For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin"* (Hebrews 4:15).

Also see

> "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'" (1 Samuel 16:7).

> "You have taken account of my wanderings. Put my tears in Your bottle— are they not in Your book?" (Psalm 56:8).

> "O LORD, You have searched me and known me. You know when I sit and when I rise; You understand my thoughts from afar. You search out my path and my lying down; You are aware of all my ways" (Psalm 139:1–3).

> "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep" (Romans 12:15).

Common self-statements

- No one believes me.
- They think I am lazy.
- I have to prove I am sick.
- I cannot explain what it is like.
- Everyone doubts me.
- I am being judged.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either see my pain or think I am faking.
- Fortune telling: Predicting disbelief.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling doubted and concluding that everyone doubts me.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a fraud.

Challenging questions

- Who believes me, even if only a few?
- What do I want others to understand?

- How do I feel when I over-explain?
- What does God see?
- How could I set a boundary with people who doubt?
- Who might benefit from a patient-support group?

Truth summary

> God sees and knows my suffering, and Jesus sympathizes. I do not have to prove my pain to everyone. I can find those who believe me and set kind boundaries with those who do not.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Suffering
- Sickness
- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Judgmental

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People think I'm faking"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People think I'm faking." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who believes me, even if only a few?
- ☐ What do I want others to understand?
- ☐ How do I feel when I over-explain?
- ☐ What does God see?
- ☐ How could I set a boundary with people who doubt?
- ☐ Who might benefit from a patient-support group?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus sympathizes with my weakness.
- ☐ God sees my heart.
- ☐ God counts my tears.
- ☐ He knows me completely.
- ☐ I do not have to prove my pain.
- ☐ Some people believe me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Hebrews 4:15
  "For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin."
- ☐ 1 Samuel 16:7
  "But the LORD said to Samuel, 'Do not consider his appearance or height, for I have rejected him; the LORD does not see as man does. For man sees the outward appearance, but the LORD sees the heart.'"
- ☐ Psalm 56:8
  "You have taken account of my wanderings. Put my tears in Your bottle— are they not in Your book?"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Believed and known: Each week, note one person who believed or supported you.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Hebrews 4:15 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus sympathizes with my weakness, and God sees my heart.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Suffering" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List supporters. Write those who take you seriously.
- [ ] Prepare a short sentence. Write one line for explaining your condition.
- [ ] Join a support group. Find people with similar conditions.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 56:8. Remember God counts your tears.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People think I'm faking": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Believed and known
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People think I'm faking.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, others doubt my pain, but You know it fully. Give me peace, supportive people, and grace to set boundaries. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.